

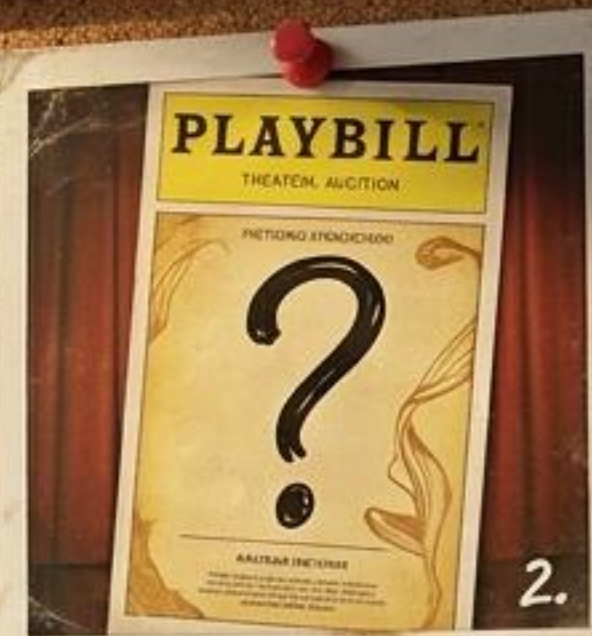


The One With The Fake Monica

A visual guide to sitcom storytelling, 90s culture, and mastering English vocabulary in context.



The Stolen Identity.



The Stage Name.



Saying Goodbye.

Episode Overview:

Three characters.
Three intersecting journeys
of identity.
One ultimate truth.

If you were linked
we make coffee, the
rocks owned what we
don't want.

Meet Monana: The Stolen Identity

Fake: Not real.

(Monica discovers a fake version of herself living her life).

Reckless: Doing something dangerous without worrying about the risks. (The thief's reckless credit card spending).

Uncoordinated: Clumsy, lacking physical control. (Monica feels entirely uncoordinated in her tap class).

Tap class: A style of dance using metal-plated shoes.



MENU

Real Monica		Fake Monica
Cautious (Careful to avoid danger)	VS.	Astounding / Wild (Incredible, untamed spirit)
Geek (Socially awkward, buys a \$70 Wonder Mop)	VS.	Charismatic (Crashes embassy parties, easily makes friends)
Tense (Stressed, anxious)	VS.	Free (Auditioning for community theater, no fear of judgment)

**The thief lives Monica's life
better than Monica does.**

Idiom Spotlight: Throw caution to the wind

Definition: To stop worrying about the risks and do something bold or reckless.

Episode Context: Ross remarks that if someone is willing to steal a credit card, they have already thrown caution to the wind.

Usage Example: Fake Monica didn't care about the consequences; she completely threw to the wind.

Item Register
Cash Register
Receipt
Credit Card

\$2.00
\$3.00

The Search for a Stage Name



- **Stage Name:** A professional alias used by actors.
- **Ethnic:** Relating to a specific cultural or national group. (Joey's agent thinks Tribbiani sounds too ethnic).
- **Neutral:** Not belonging to any particular side or specific group. (Joey needs a name that sounds neutral).
- **Starring / Auditioning:** To be the lead actor / To try out for a role.

Romeo & Juliet: Mercutio

Joey Tribbiani
(Too ethnic)

↓
Joe
(Better, but needs a last name)

↓
Chandler suggests Joseph Stalin
(sarcastic joke about the Soviet
dictator who slaughtered
millions).

↓
Joey doesn't recognize the
name and proudly adopts it.

↓
Joey discovers the truth, panics,
and auditions under a new fake
name: Holden McGroin (a crude
anatomical pun).

Language Insight: Sarcasm relies on shared cultural knowledge.
When vocabulary (or history) is missing, the joke backfires!



Saying Goodbye to Marcel

- **Vet (Veterinarian):** An animal doctor.
- **Phase:** A temporary period of development. (Ross hopes Marcel's humping is just a phase).
- **Maturity:** Reaching full physical development. (Marcel has reached sexual maturity).
- **Aggressive:** Ready or likely to attack. (The vet warns Marcel will become aggressive).
- **Access:** The ability or right to approach something.

Zoo Application Funnel

Tier 1: Scranton Zoo (The Safety):
Rejected. They only take farm animals.

Tier 2: Dr. Baldhara's (The Danger):
An interactive wildlife experience.
(Interactive - hands-on;
Vicious - cruel or violent;
Docile - submissive/gentle;
Cornered - trapped).
Ross realizes this is a horrifying
animal fighting ring!

Tier 3: San Diego Zoo
(The Dream):
Accepted!
A world-class facility.

"The One With Fake Monkeys"

ROSS

No, the vet said unless he's in a place where he has regular access to some... monkey loving, he's gonna get vicious. I've got to get him into a zoo.

JOEY

How do you get a monkey into a zoo?



Pipe Dream.

A fantasy or hope that is impossible to achieve.

Context: Ross thinks getting Marcel into the famous San Diego Zoo is just a pipe dream.



Take the brunt.

To suffer the main force or impact of something bad.

Context: When Marcel's aggressive behavior ruins the apartment, Phoebe jokes that the wooden chair is taking the brunt of it.



Wonder Mop.

A famous 1990s TV infomercial cleaning product. Monica's purchase of this marks her as a geek.

Pennsylvania Dutch / Amish.

A traditional, plain-living religious group in the US. Fake Monica assumes Monica is Amish because she is so tense and rule-abiding.

Dead Poets Society.

A dramatic 1989 film. Fake Monica missed the emotional point and just found it boring, inspiring her life of crime.

Broadway.

The famous theater district in New York. Joey and Monana both dream of acting here.

The Theme: Identity & The Inevitability of Change

Monica tries to be a reckless, wild version of herself, but ultimately realizes she is inherently a cautious rule-follower.

Joey tries to adopt a fake, sophisticated name, but his lack of knowledge exposes who he truly is.

Marcel naturally grows up, proving you cannot stop biological change.

The Lesson: *You cannot fight who you truly are.*



AUDITION
- FRIENDS -

SIGN IN AT:

Joseph Stalin





Diner

Comprehension Check (True or False)

1. Monica reports the credit card thief to the police immediately. (T/F)
2. Chandler suggests the name Joseph Stalin because he genuinely thinks it sounds like a good actor. (T/F)
3. Ross realizes Marcel's humping is just a temporary phase. (T/F)
4. Monica feels uncoordinated during the tap dance class. (T/F)
5. Dr. Baldhara runs a highly respected, traditional state zoo. (T/F)

Name: _____

RECEIPT PRINTER / 100-07-401232

Time: _____

Date: _____

Short Answer Challenge

Q1: How did Fake Monica's reckless behavior contrast with Real Monica's personality?

Q2: Why did Joey want a neutral stage name, and how did his lack of historical knowledge ruin it?

Q3: Explain why getting Marcel into the San Diego zoo was initially considered a pipe dream.

No. 2

2



Great job!
You've mastered
the vocabulary
of Season 1,
Episode 21.
Keep throwing
caution to
the wind in in your English practice!

Diner

Comprehension Check (True or False)

1. Monica reports the credit card theft to the police immediately. (T/F) **1. False**
2. Chandler suggests the name Joseph Stalin because he genuinely thinks sounds like a good actor. (T/F) **2. False**
3. Ross realizes Marcel's humping is just a temporary phase. (T/F) **3. False**
4. Monica feels uncoordinated during the tap dance class. (T/F) **4. True**
5. Dr. Baladhara runs a highly respected traditional state zoo. (T/F) **5. False**

One With Fake Monica - Final Draft 3/3/95

AL
(31/8)

SCENE X

INT. AIRPORT TERMINAL - JACOBO TEST MAY - (368) 11
IRACELI, PHOEBE, ROSS, CHANDLER, SUZIE, ROBERTA
THE CROWD. SEVE MONICA. IS READING SOMETHING TO MARCEL.
ON AIALINE REFRESHMENT LOUNGE DO, HOLDING THE COTY
CAGE.

PHOEBE

Goodbye, little monkey guy. I'm
going to miss you. Here's a poem I
wrote for you. Don't eat it till
you get on the plane.

SHE PUTS THE PIECE OF PAPER IN THE CAGE, THEN TURNS
AWAY, COOKING BACK THE TEARS.

PHOEBE (CONT'D)

I'm okay.

CHANDLER

(TO MARCEL) Bye, champ. Listen. I
know there's going to be a lot of
babes in San Diego, but remember...
there's also a lot to learn.

IT'S JOEY'S TURN. HE'S UNCOMFORTABLE.

JOEY

I don't know what to say. It's
monkey.